

Research Design 2026 — next steps

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Next steps

Updated 2026-09-10. Session 1 is Tue Sep 15 (5 days). Sessions: Sep 15, 22, 29, Oct 6, 13. Workshop Mon Oct 26. Essay due Tue Oct 27.

Session 1 is **ready**: deck, notes version, teaching guide, and the 2026 syllabus are all built and compile clean. What follows is everything still outstanding.

Settled — no action needed

- **Essay deadline Oct 27** confirmed against the exam calendar.
 - **Group formation**: no separate deadline. Whoever submits **Memo 5 together (Mon Oct 19)** is a group, and that grouping is binding for the presentation and the essay. In the syllabus and on the workshop slide.
 - **The two worked examples** (hotel bookings, Spotify) are labelled just “examples” on the slides. Mention on the spot that they are real theses or course projects, without naming anyone.
 - **Charlie Kirk stays** as the session-2 running example for now. Revisit later; the slot is marked % SWAPPABLE: so the structure survives a swap.
 - **Memos get no written feedback**. Questions in class are welcome, and raising things that struck you while reading them is fine, but nothing formal and nothing announced.
 - Aula Global assignments set up; syllabus PDF pushed.
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Before each session — the decks

Only session 1 exists so far. Each new deck goes in `reframing_2026/slides/`, built from `08_outline_2026.md` and adjusted for how the previous session actually went.

By Sep 22 — session 2, “Questions and data” (the big build)

- ☐ Split `2_basics_quantitative_data/` into the RQ/theory front half plus a new provenance block
- ☐ Build the data-provenance block (~28 frames): designed vs found, Salganik’s ten characteristics, Xbox, Google Flu, algorithmic confounding, post-API access, ethics preview
- ☐ Move **levels of explanation** (macro/meso/micro) here from the measurement material
- ☐ Source two figures: **CDC vs GFT** over-prediction, and the **Xbox** demographic skew
- ☐ Mark the Charlie Kirk slot % SWAPPABLE:

By Sep 29 — session 3, “Measurement and description”

- ☐ Assemble from the existing back half of `basics_quant_data.tex` (mostly exists, just needs room)
- ☐ Add classifier-output-as-a-variable, using the Barberá images already in `img/`
- ☐ Add Obermeyer proxy failure; expand the description block with Chetty and culturomics
- ☐ Source figures: Obermeyer cost-vs-illness, an Opportunity Insights map, n-gram + corpus composition

By Oct 6 — session 4, “Causality” (cheapest week, mostly deletion)

- ☐ Trim `causality.tex` 91 → ~55 frames; PO example 8 → 5; Off topic: Controlling 4 → 1
- ☐ Restore the commented-out **prediction** frames (1–2, since the triad carries the load now)
- ☐ Add platform experiments and their limits (Guess + Bail), and interference-as-normal-in-CSS
- ☐ Source the Bail treatment-effect-by-party figure

By Oct 13 — session 5, “Designs and credibility”

- ☐ **Cut Causal methods again, in detail** (~65 frames) to `slides/appendix_methods_detail/`. Move, don’t delete
- ☐ Merge `causal_inference.tex` block A with the first ~45 frames of `advanced.tex`
- ☐ Compress meta-analysis 10 → 5; move synthetic control to the appendix
- ☐ Build the credibility block (forking paths, Breznau, pre-registration) and the ethics block
- ☐ Build the closing prediction-revisited frames (Fragile Families) and the return to the triad
- ☐ Present **Villamil & Balcells** as your own worked DiD, including what you’d do differently
- ☐ Source figures: Breznau distribution-of-estimates, Fragile Families scatter

By Oct 23 — workshop materials

- ☐ Pair the groups once Memo 5 is in (Oct 19), and circulate each sketch to its partner
 - ☐ Write the peer-review sheet (written comments, handed in, graded on the group)
 - ☐ Slot schedule: ~12 slots, 12 min + 8 min, hard stop
 - ☐ Required-slides list, including “**the threat I can’t solve**”
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Carried over

- ☐ **Apply the 40-student pass to the session-1 teaching notes.** They still say “let silences sit” (line ~396) and treat the Socratic blocks as if this were a seminar of twelve. With 40 people, silence gets filled by the same three voices. Needs think-pair-share throughout: pose, 60 seconds silent, 2 minutes in pairs, take 3–4 contributions — and call on *pairs*, not individuals. Also: make the three unit-of-analysis graphs a show of hands.
- ☐ **Teaching notes for sessions 2–5.** Only session 1 has one.
- ☐ **Em-dash pass on the plan docs and teaching notes.** Done for the syllabus and slides; the rest still has them (167 in the session-1 teaching notes, 143 in the outline).
- ☐ **Decide when the new decks replace `res_design/slides/`.** The old decks are untouched and still what `index.md` would link to.
- ☐ `index.md`: add slide PDF links as each deck is finished.

Housekeeping

- ☐ Adopt the two-wrapper notes pattern in decks 2–5 as they are built (session 1 already has it; `slides/beamer_notes_preamble.tex` exists and is reusable).

- Build artifacts (`.aux`, `.nav`, `.snm`, `.toc`, `.fdb_latexmk`, `.syncTeX.gz`) are cluttering both slide trees, and there is a stray `files/survivorship_bias_copy.png`. **Ask before deleting**, and check `.gitignore` covers them going forward.